10.10 The Neutropenic Patient

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "Why must I wear a mask and avoid visitors?" **Objective** • Neutrophils 0.5 × 10^9/L • Has just had chemotherapy	**ACTUAL** **Deficient knowledge** related to infection prevention during neutropenia as evidenced by questions.	Within 24 hours, can describe the infection precautions.	• Explain what neutropenia is and when the counts will be lowest. • Teach hand hygiene and food safety (food cooked well, fruit washed). • Tell him to report a temperature of 38 °C or more straight away.	Describes the precautions: **goal met**.
Subjective • "I feel lonely in this room." **Objective** • In protective isolation • Few visitors	**ACTUAL** **Social isolation** related to protective isolation as evidenced by expressed loneliness.	Says he feels less lonely.	• Drop in regularly, not only when a task needs doing. • Encourage phone and video calls. • Allow visitors who are well and follow the precautions.	Less lonely: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Neutropenia severe • Central line in situ	**RISK** **Risk for infection** as evidenced by risk factors: neutropenia and invasive device.	No infection.	• Check the mouth, skin, perianal area and line every day. • Avoid invasive procedures where you can. • Give the growth factor as prescribed.	No infection: **goal met**.